Ishkhan Khchoian

Product Manager — conversational AI, discovery & 0-to-1

Yerevan, Armenia · remote, or on-site / hybrid in Yerevan · open to relocation
+374 98 60 34 64 · ishxanxchoyan@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/ishkhan-khchoian-2419182b3
English (C1) · Russian (native) · Armenian (native)

IN SHORT

Product manager with over six years of experience managing projects and client work across different business areas. I am currently COO of SayWhen.am, a working AI voice-agent product, where I run development with the CTO and manage the company's corporate clients across the full engagement cycle. Before that I redesigned client-project processes at U.S. companies — a strictly six-month cycle, new express tracks and a 35% higher success rate. I completed an IT project management course through a U.S. Embassy program and am taking the PSM I exam in November 2026. Conversational AI is not a box I am ticking for this application — it is what I already chose to work on.

WHY THIS ROLE SPECIFICALLY

- **Conversational AI.** As COO of SayWhen.am I work on AI voice agents and RAG systems for B2B — vertical-specific, aimed at enterprise clients and tenders. I have spent my own time on where these interfaces break: retrieval quality, handover to a human, and what users actually say versus what you expect them to say.
- **Discovery and user research.** Client intake was my daily work for six years — structured interviews with people who describe a symptom and not the problem. That is the same muscle a product discovery call uses, and I have run it several hundred times.
- **Turning ideas into clear specs.** At M&M I rewrote the internal workflow — templates, checklists, hand-offs — and it became how the team works by default. Writing something precise enough that other people can execute it without me is the part I enjoy most.
- **Process redesign with measurable results.** At one U.S. company I rebuilt the client-project workflow: the cycle became strictly six months or less, two- and four-month express tracks were introduced, errors decreased, and the share of successful cases rose by 35%.
- **Founder-adjacent work.** I am used to being the person a principal delegates the ambiguous half of the problem to — I stood in for the team lead at Shamayev and was the escalation point at M&M.
- **Time zone.** Yerevan is UTC+4: my afternoon is your morning, so a CET/CEST team gets a solid overlap without either of us working nights.

PRODUCT & TECH TRACK

- **SayWhen.am, COO** — working AI voice-agent product (demo on request); RAG for B2B, with separate verticals per industry.
- **HackNation** — 2nd place, local pitches; competed in the on-site final at TUMO Labs, Yerevan (July 2026).
- **42 Yerevan — Piscine**, Nov–Dec 2025. Passed selection; one month of C and peer-reviewed projects, done while holding a full-time job.
- **Startup Seaside Summit** — participant.
- **Project management** — "Project Management with a U.S. Perspective: Skills for Global Success," Yerevan American Corner, a joint program of the U.S. Embassy Yerevan and the City Central Isahakyan Library; Jul 21 – Aug 21, 2026, in person, Certificate of Achievement. Earlier: PM Club, 52 hours (2023).
- **Professional Scrum Master I (Scrum.org)** — exam scheduled for November 2026.

SKILLS

- **Product:** user interviews and discovery · writing requirements, user stories and acceptance criteria · backlog grooming · roadmap input · experiment design · metric definition and tracking · competitor and market research
- **Delivery:** scope and timelines · Scrum and Kanban · Gantt charts · risk tracking · SOPs and checklists people actually follow · cross-functional coordination

- **Analytical:** six years of legal analysis: reading a dense corpus, finding the one clause that decides the outcome, and defending the reasoning in writing
- **Tools:** Jira · Confluence · Miro · Notion · Trello · Monday · Postman · Bitrix24 · amoCRM · Google Analytics · Google Workspace · Claude Code

EXPERIENCE

COO — SayWhen.am (AI voice-agent startup)
Feb 2026 – present

- Run product development with the CTO in Jira and Confluence: requirements, specification, backlog and priorities, and acceptance of each stage.
- Manage the company's corporate clients across the full engagement cycle: needs discovery, agreement on scope and timelines, and regular progress reporting during implementation.

Freelance — project and legal work
Feb 2026 – present

- Designed a U.S. client-acquisition pilot for **Karas Systems** (B2B go-to-market consultancy): a three-scenario funnel model, budget, payback and decision gates.
- Business research for a water production line; CPA/affiliate manager (under NDA); legal projects — IP assignment for works by popular musicians, a corporate structure for a crypto trader and advice on opening a crypto-exchange office in Armenia; sale of family real estate.

Senior Case Manager — M&M Document Preparation (U.S.)
Jun 2025 – Feb 2026

- Owned up to **12 complex client projects at a time**, end to end, against fixed external deadlines.
- Redesigned the delivery process: a cycle of **strictly six months or less**, new **two- and four-month express tracks**, fewer errors through a shared knowledge base, and a **35% higher success rate**.
- Coordinated **8 specialists** and reviewed their work against written acceptance criteria; my templates, checklists and hand-off rules became the team standard.

Event / Project Manager — Hosq Corp.
Jan 2025 – Jun 2025

- Delivered live events for **100 to 3,000** people — several in parallel, on dates that could not slip; owned vendors, logistics, scheduling and day-of operations.

Project Manager — Qanon Construction
Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

- Client communication, scope agreement, timelines and internal follow-through.

Legal practice — U.S. law firms, Arbitration Court, Bar Association
Dec 2019 – Aug 2024

- Senior Paralegal at Shamayev Business Law, Paralegal at Bloomrich Law Firm: built the internal training program **Paralegal Academy** (50+ people) and improved the firms' internal processes.
- Judge's Associate: **200+ concurrent cases, 30+ hearings a week**; earlier, contract analysis and claims work at a Bar Association.

Project Manager — SIS LLC (family business)
Jun 2015 – Sep 2019

- Managed projects including an **investment project made up of 11 public and private tenders worth RUB 42M** — every site delivered **on time and accepted with no defects noted**.
- Teams of up to 20; procurement, logistics between sites and recruiting; built the first schedules and Gantt charts; set up a regional supply network for the retail business.

EDUCATION & OTHER

- **Bachelor of Law, with honors** — North-Eastern State University, 2021.
- **Civil Law, Faculty of Law** — St. Petersburg State University, 2016.
- **Highload++** (700 attendees) — organizing team, led 12 people; special assignments and a performance bonus.
- **Ethos Foundation** — HQ coordinator, Sep 2023 – Oct 2024; humanitarian distribution to ~100 families a day.